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gashed – cut deeply

hysterics – a fit of uncontrollable laughing or crying

exasperation – irritation

catastrophe – a terrible disaster

bons mots – (French) witty remarks

suave – polite and sophisticated

venerable – valued

Bill – William (the letter W is changed to B and William is called Bill)

A. Based on your understanding of the lesson, answer the following questions in one or two sentences each:

1. Give a few instances of Bryson's confused acts.
2. What were the contents of the bag?
3. Describe the fluttery cascade of things tumbling from the bag.
4. Why did the author's concern over tobacco shift to his finger?
5. What happened to Bryson when he leaned to tie his shoelace?
6. How did Bryson free himself from the crash position?
7. Give a brief account of the embarrassing situation of Bryson when he knocked down the drink.
8. What was Bryson's worst accident on a plane?
9. What did Bryson wish to avoid in his life?
10. How would staying away from liquid mischief benefit Bryson?

B. Answer the following questions in about three to four sentences each:

1. Why doesn't Bryson seem to be able to do easily what others seem to? Give a few reasons.
2. What was the reaction of Bryson's wife to his antics?
3. Briefly describe the 'accidents' encountered on the flight by Bryson.

C. Based on your understanding of the text, answer the following questions in a paragraph of about 100 – 150 words:

1. 'To this day, I don't know how I did it' - What does 'it' refer to?
2. '… But, when it's my own - well, I think hysterics are fully justified' – How?
3. Bring out the pun in the title 'The Accidental Tourist' (one who happens to travel by accident or one who meets with accidents often on his or her trips!).
4. Can a clumsy person train himself/herself to overcome shortcomings? How could this be done?
5. As a fellow passenger of Bill Bryson on the flight, make a diary entry describing his clumsy behaviour during the trip and the inconveniences caused to others as a result of his nervousness.